

JENNIFER M. LAVELLE

BENEFITS LEADER | BUSINESS & PEOPLE ADVOCATE | INNOVATOR

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Dynamic and accomplished human resources leader with deep expertise in corporate benefits and total rewards. Demonstrated success in developing strategy, ensuring regulatory compliance, optimizing HR technologies, and leading end-to-end benefits administration for nationwide employers across private and public sectors. Recognized for building and guiding high-performing teams, cultivating talent, and fostering strong cross-functional partnerships to enhance operational effectiveness and drive organizational efficiency.

KEY STRENGTHS

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| ❖ Market Competitiveness & Cost-Effectiveness | ❖ Senior Management Counsel & Board Relations |
| ❖ Benefits Planning, Strategy, & Partnerships | ❖ OD, OE, & Continuous Improvement |
| ❖ Technical & Compliance Expertise | ❖ System Development, Implementation & Migration |
| ❖ Benefits Committee Governance | ❖ Change Management & Organizational Impact |

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Manager, Benefits

Cleveland State University

June 2025 - present

Lead benefits strategy and operations, directing the design and administration of health, welfare, retirement, and absence programs while driving planning, compliance, communications, and wellness initiatives for faculty and staff.

- **Strengthened compliance** and secured more favorable vendor terms by leading comprehensive contract reviews, renegotiations, and risk assessments across key benefit programs, resulting in savings of \$20k.
- **Enhanced employee experience** by redesigning the customer service delivery model, improving issue resolution, increasing satisfaction, and driving more consistent benefit outcomes.
- **Leading benefits and absence workstreams** for Workday ERP implementation, aligning processes, data, and integrations to support a seamless transition and long-term operational efficiency.
- **Improved employee understanding and engagement** through revamped benefits communications, expanded training programs, and people leader town halls tailored to diverse employee groups.
- **Elevated the campus wellness program** by expanding offerings, increasing participation, and representing HR at wellness events to promote a culture of health and well-being.
- **Serving on a cross-functional team** in evaluating and negotiating new terms for the on-site health clinic, ensuring improved service delivery, cost effectiveness, and alignment with organizational needs.
- **Contributed to university-wide initiatives**—including employee handbook creation and policy reviews, strengthening governance, ensuring compliance, and promoting consistent HR practices.

Benefits Director

Consolidated Precision Products Corp.

June 2024 - April 2025

Corporate benefits leader overseeing strategy and administration of health, absence, and retirement programs for 3,000+ U.S.-based union and non-union employees across 20+ states. Selected to leverage deep expertise to advance functional excellence and strengthen collaboration and efficiency across HR teams within a rapidly growing global organization.

- **Facilitated comprehensive audits** of contract provisions, vendor roles and responsibilities, and carrier billing. Successfully identified and resolved numerous discrepancies, resulting in over \$250K in annual savings.
- **Uncovered significant and costly compliance issues** during acquisition due diligence, empowering the organization to incorporate remediation provisions and to safeguard the employees assets.
- **Formalized an internal technology review process**, developing comprehensive data and process mappings, significantly enhancing integrity, accuracy, and identification of lower-performing carrier partners leading to a formal RFP effort.
- **Broadened health plan options**, adding voluntary plans that strengthen employees' unforeseen expenses protection.
- **Launched comprehensive Medicare support** tools that reduce costs for employees and the organization and provide reliable guidance on emerging coverage alternatives.
- **Initiated education and alignment for the broader HR group** using live training and educational sessions to increase benefits program and process knowledge at all levels.
- **Shaped internal communications strategy** to engage key stakeholders and elevate the employee experience. Pioneered the introduction of enhanced technology solutions for the delivery of candidate and employee insights.

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Director, Employee Benefits

Kforce Inc.

April 2022 - June 2024

Directed strategy development and administration of health, welfare, retirement, and absence benefits offerings for 8K+ associates and consultants in the dynamic staffing industry. Drove a renewed focus on stakeholder experience, engagement, compliance and scalability to support business growth.

- **Championed cost-containment initiative** that uncovered \$2.5M in annual savings for employees and the Firm, establishing a balanced approach to rising health plan costs that lessened employee impact and aligned with organizational values.
- **Defined critical vendor partner requirements** to streamline administration, eliminate redundancies and ensure contract adherence; successfully renewed key agreements, generating \$300K+ in savings.
- **Fostered unity and cross-functional collaboration** while expanding the team's contextual view to promote alignment with the Firm's priorities, deliver needed partner education, and promote a proactive outreach and advocacy culture. .
- **Redesigned absence management** support, communications, and policies to improve education and ensure compliance with federal, state, local, and company requirements.

Director of Benefits

Flynn Restaurant Group

February 2018 - April 2022

Managed benefits strategy, design, and delivery of health, welfare, retirement, absence, and unemployment benefits across six concepts in 40+ states, supporting 70K+ team members. Strengthened processes and infrastructure to support large-scale acquisitions and integrations.

- **Spearheaded major benefits (re)design** initiative resulting in comprehensive, cost-effective offerings across all brands.
- **Nurtured a culture of ownership and accountability** by resolving long-standing field issues, addressing training needs, and strengthening HR service delivery.
- **Coached and developed a high-performing benefits team**, building strong collaboration, support, and readiness for internal advancement and succession.
- **Enhanced internal communications** to improve understanding of benefit options, strengthen employee education, and expand in-house benefits training.
- **Partnered with internal and external legal counsel** to design and implement a formal leave of absence billing policy that ensured compliance with local, state, and federal regulations and reduced risks following furloughs.

Sr. Manager, Corporate Benefits

Windstream, formerly EarthLink, Inc.

June 2004 - January 2018

Steered strategy development and execution, partnering with key stakeholders to define organizational needs and consolidate benefit plans following significant M&A activity - building a best-in-class infrastructure for 3,000 benefits-eligible associates across 35+ states, Canada, and global expatriate populations.

- **Selected as the sole resource to manage end-of-life benefits migration** for EarthLink associates during the Windstream merger - ensuring each associate received clear guidance and compassionate support.
- **Elevated benefits customer service** by identifying opportunities to improve efficiency, enhance end-user experiences, and drive cost containment and reduction.
- **Communicated benefit changes throughout the organization**—from advising executive leadership and the board on policy, process, and plan design updates to developing employee-level materials that support informed decision-making.
- **Oversaw bi-weekly payroll processing** and maintained compliance with local, state, and federal regulations through policy and procedure updates.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts in Human Resources Management | Baldwin Wallace University – *December 2026*

AWARDS

2023 - Bowl Winning Team, Kforce | 2020 - "Own It", Flynn | 2019 - New Employee of the Year, Flynn
2018 - Circle of Excellence, EarthLink | 2007 - Hermes Creative, EarthLink | 2007 - Communicator, EarthLink